PRE-WORK WORKBOOK

Coaching Fundamentals

Essential Concepts

Use this workbook while you complete the e-learning.
Bring it, completed, to the Coaching Fundamentals workshop.

Name

Area / district

Date completed

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WORKBOOK GUIDE

How to use this workbook

The e-learning has four modules. When a screen shows a **workbook activity**, pause the module, turn to the page shown, and write your answers. There are seven activities and two quick reference pages. Activity 3 asks you to plan a real coaching conversation with one of your reps: you will use that plan in the workshop.

The coaching process at a glance

Stage	What you do
P · Plan Build a focused plan	• Review the data: last co-visit report, your notes, sales and activity data, agreed actions, customer plans • Assess the rep's demonstrated ability and willingness for a specific task • Choose one to three tasks to focus on, and the style you will use
I · Implement Coach the conversation	• Observe the focus tasks and assess them against clear standards • Ask for the rep's view first • Give feedback based on observable behaviour • Explore ideas together and commit to specific actions
E · Evaluate Keep coaching going	• Document the behaviours observed and the actions agreed, with dates • Follow up between visits and reinforce progress • Re-assess readiness and plan the next conversation

Activities in this workbook

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ACTIVITY 1 · MODULE 1

My Coaching Today

> Think of the last three times you coached one of your reps. Be honest: nobody will grade this page.

#	**Where did it happen?** (co-visit, monthly review, phone call…)	**What did you focus on?**	**How useful was it for the rep?**
1			1 2 3 4 5
2			1 2 3 4 5
3			1 2 3 4 5

Reflect

In these conversations, did I mostly tell, or mostly ask? Why?

Which feedback did I give most: reinforce, enhance or correct?

One thing I want to do differently as a coach after this course

ACTIVITY 2 · MODULE 2

Break It Down

> Choose one competency your team needs most. Break it down into a skill, one specific task, and the behaviours you would see and hear when the task is done well. Use a real situation from your territory.

Example

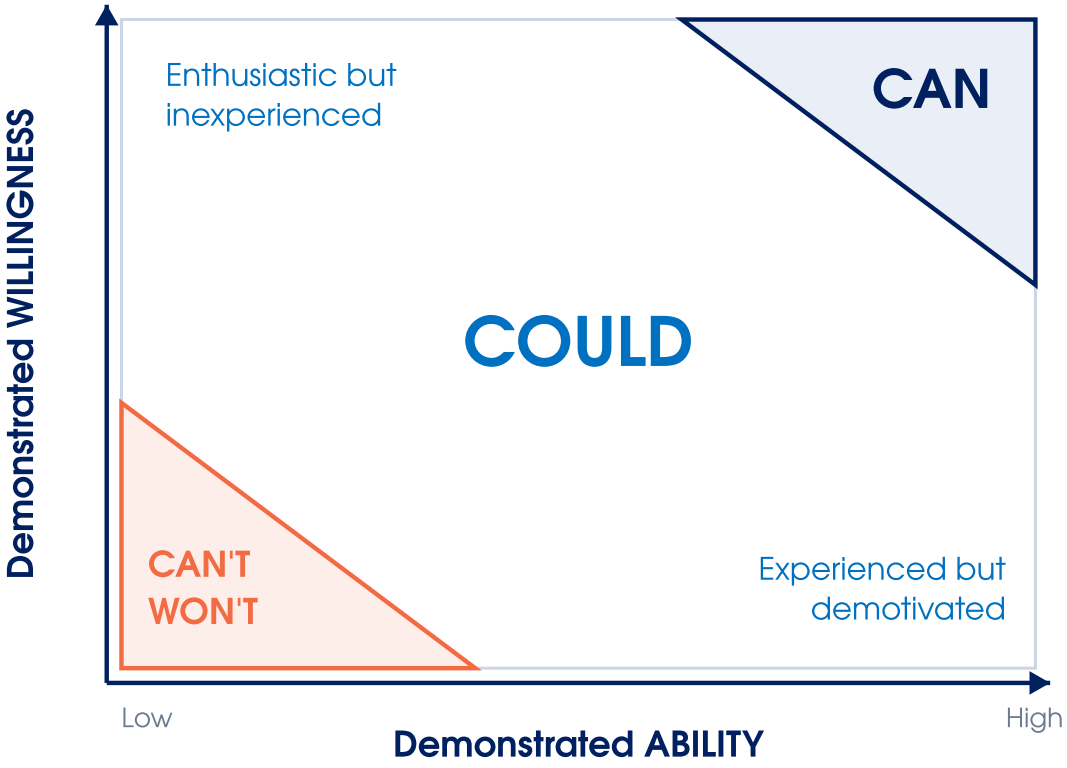
Level	Example
Competency	*Customer interaction*
Skill	*Engage and sell*
Task	*Open the call and identify the doctor's needs for the target patient group*
Behaviours	*1. Links the opening to the doctor's own practice* *2. Asks at least two open questions about the patients he sees* *3. Summarises what the doctor said before presenting*

Your turn

Level	Your example
Competency	
Skill	
Task	
Behaviours	1. 2. 3.

Readiness by Task

Readiness is a combination of **demonstrated ability** (knowledge, experience, skill) and **demonstrated willingness** (confidence, motivation) **for one specific task**. It describes performance on that task, not the whole person. The same rep can be at different levels for different tasks.



Level	What you may observe
CAN Needs to stretch	Makes sound decisions to get results; finds fresh ways to meet customer needs; flags problems and opportunities early; helps develop other reps.
COULD Needs to expand skills	**Enthusiastic but inexperienced:** asks many questions; takes on more than they can handle; delivers results with some setbacks.
COULD Needs to engage	**Experienced but demotivated:** avoids initiative or avoids the manager; low motivation hides real ability; can affect team spirit.
CAN'T Needs to learn the basics	Lacks skill and experience for the task; unsure how to move forward; lacks confidence; may not see the problem.
WON'T Needs to turn around	Unacceptable or marginal performance on the task, sustained or repeated; does not own the problem; may be defensive.

ACTIVITY 3 · MODULE 2

Plan a Coaching Conversation

Choose one real rep you will co-visit in the coming weeks. You will bring this plan to the workshop and use it in practice.

Rep (first name)

Planned co-visit date

1. Data I will review

- [ ] Last co-visit report and agreed actions
- [ ] My own notes
- [ ] Sales achievement, coverage and call frequency
- [ ] Customer plans for key doctors and pharmacies
- [ ] Annual objectives and development goals
- [ ] Other:

2. What the data tells me

3. The one task I will focus on

Evidence of ability on this task

Evidence of willingness on this task

4. Readiness level for this task (circle one)

CAN | COULD: enthusiastic but inexperienced | COULD: experienced but demotivated | CAN'T | WON'T

5. The coaching style I will use (circle one)

Directive | Participative | Encouraging

ACTIVITY 4 · MODULE 3

Judgment or Behaviour?

Tick **J** if the statement is a judgment, or **B** if it describes observable behaviour. Then rewrite three judgments as behaviour-based feedback. Answers are on page 12.

#	Feedback statement	J	B
1	"You were too pushy with Dr. Amal."	☐	☐
2	"You mentioned the price twice before she asked about it."	☐	☐
3	"You don't care about pharmacies."	☐	☐
4	"You asked three open questions about her elderly patients before presenting."	☐	☐
5	"Your detailing was boring."	☐	☐
6	"You left the clinic without agreeing a next step with the doctor."	☐	☐
7	"You seemed nervous today."	☐	☐
8	"When he raised the efficacy objection, you showed him the study result on page 3."	☐	☐
9	"You have a negative attitude in cycle meetings."	☐	☐
10	"You arrived after the clinic started, so you waited 40 minutes to see him."	☐	☐

Rewrite three judgments as behaviour

Statement # ___ rewritten

_____

_____

Statement # ___ rewritten

_____

_____

Statement # ___ rewritten

_____

_____

QUICK REFERENCE · MODULE 3

Coaching Styles: What You Do

Match your style to the rep's readiness **for the task**. As readiness grows, your style moves from Directive to Participative to Encouraging.

Readiness	Style	What you do
CAN'T Learn the basics	**Directive** High guidance	• Give specific direction on what to do and how • Explain what they most need to learn • Pair them with an experienced peer; meet often to give feedback • Provide practice and any training needed • Encourage and express confidence when deserved • Check in regularly
WON'T Turn it around	**Directive** Highest guidance	• State clearly the gap against the standard • Explain the consequences of not improving • Supervise improvement closely • Involve HR and your own manager when needed • Agree a written action plan with specific expectations and deadlines
COULD Enthusiastic but inexperienced	**Participative** Moderate guidance, high support	• Ask how they would approach it; support their ideas where possible • Refine ideas; suggest other approaches or resources • Help them set realistic limits on new tasks
COULD Experienced but demotivated	**Participative** Balanced guidance and support	• Clarify mutual expectations about initiative and checking in • Show, with examples, how the behaviour affects results and the team • Decide how much direction is needed • Explore root causes and agree what will change
CAN Stretch	**Encouraging** High support	• Clarify the outcomes you want • Let them decide what and how • Share ideas or best practice only if asked • Remove barriers for them • Keep giving feedback and recognition

ACTIVITY 5 · MODULE 3

Match the Style

For each case, decide the readiness level for the task described, choose the coaching style, and write the first sentence you would say. Answers are on page 12.

A · Nour

Nour joined five months ago. She is energetic and always volunteers. Next week she must present to a hospital pharmacy committee for the first time. She has never done this and keeps asking colleagues what to say. **Task: presenting to a pharmacy committee.**

Readiness	Style	My first sentence to the rep

B · Karim

Karim has six years' experience and was the district's top rep two years ago. His calls are still good when you join him, but his call frequency has dropped, his reports are late, and he stays silent in cycle meetings. **Task: planning and achieving call frequency.**

Readiness	Style	My first sentence to the rep

C · Mai

Mai has two years with the company and the strongest relationships with key consultants in the district. She spots changes in hospital tenders early and already helps a new colleague prepare. **Task: managing her key hospital accounts.**

Readiness	Style	My first sentence to the rep

D · Omar

Omar has been with the company 18 months. For the third month his call frequency is below 60%. You have discussed it twice. He blames the territory and says the target is unrealistic. **Task: achieving agreed call frequency.**

Readiness	Style	My first sentence to the rep

Coach O.F.T.E.N. and Script Your Opening

Step	What you do	Sounds like
O · Open	Set a positive tone and the purpose; ask for the rep's view	*"How do you feel the call with Dr. Sherif went?"*
F · Focus	Agree the one to three tasks that matter most and their impact	*"Let's focus on how you opened the call."*
T · Transition	Describe observable behaviours and their impact; gain agreement	*"You started presenting before asking about his patients."*
E · Engage	Explore ideas for improvement; tell or ask according to the style	*"What could you ask first next time?"*
N · Next steps	Commit to specific actions, timing and follow-up	*"So in your next three calls you will... and I'll call you Thursday."*

The structure is the same for every style. Directive: you tell more. Participative: you ask and build together. Encouraging: the rep leads.

Activity 6. Use the rep and task from Activity 3. Write the words you will actually say.

O · How I will open and ask for the rep's view

F · How I will state the focus

T · One piece of behaviour-based feedback I expect to give

ACTIVITY 7 · MODULE 4

My Follow-Up Plan

> For the same rep from Activity 3, plan how you will keep the coaching going after the conversation.

Action the rep will take	By when	How I will check

Check-in 1: date and format

Check-in 2: date and format

What progress I will look for, and how I will reinforce it

What I will write on the co-visit form (keep it short)

Before the workshop: checklist

- [ ] I completed all four modules and knowledge checks
- [ ] I completed Activities 1 to 7
- [ ] My plan for one real rep (Activity 3) is ready
- [ ] I wrote down one coaching situation I find difficult, to discuss in the workshop:

ANSWER KEY

Answers for Activities 4 and 5

Activity 4 · Judgment or Behaviour?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
J	B	J	B	J	B	J	B	J	B

Behaviour statements describe what anyone present could see and hear. Judgments describe your interpretation, and the rep can argue with them.

Sample rewrite of #1: *"When Dr. Amal said she needed to see patients, you continued presenting for three more minutes."*
Sample rewrite of #7: *"You read the visual aid word for word and did not look up during the key message."*

Activity 5 · Match the Style

Case	Readiness	Style	Why, and a possible first sentence
A · Nour	CAN'T (enthusiastic, but no skill yet for this task)	Directive	She is willing but has never done it. *"Let's prepare this together: I'll walk you through what the committee expects, then you practise it with me tomorrow."*
B · Karim	COULD (experienced but demotivated)	Participative	The ability is there; motivation has dropped. *"Karim, your calls are still strong, but your frequency has fallen. Help me understand what has changed for you."*
C · Mai	CAN	Encouraging	High ability and willingness for this task. *"You know these accounts better than anyone. What would you do next, and what can I remove from your way?"*
D · Omar	WON'T	Directive	Sustained gap, already discussed, no ownership. *"Omar, for three months frequency has been under 60% against an agreed 90%. Today we will agree a written plan with weekly checks."*

Readiness is about the task described. Nour might be a COULD for routine GP calls; Mai might need Participative coaching on a task that is new to her.